

Date	Name	Location	Description
1942-08-29 ^[67]	Army Air Corps Flying School ^[67]	near <u>Flying School, Columbus, Missouri</u> ^{[67][68]}	Control tower operator observes two reddish colored round objects descend-hover-accelerate away ^[67]
1944-08-10 ^[69]	468th Bomb Group ^[70]	20-30 minutes airflight time from <u>Palembang, Sumatra</u> ^[70]	After midnight, returning from a bombing mission at an altitude of 14000 feet, speed "about 210 mph": 500 yards (about 457 meters) from the starboard an object appeared which the pilot estimated at the distance viewed was "probably 5-6 feet in diameter" (1.5-1.8 meters) - "intense red or orange" color - throbbed or vibrated constantly. The object followed the bomber for about 8 minutes while the pilot attempted evasive manoeuvres at the same 500 yard distance. The object flew "up" and away at a "90 degree" angle "accelerating rapidly". ^[70]
1945	<u>Trinity UFO Case</u>	United States; <u>New Mexico</u>	In 2003, two men began telling conflicting accounts of an avocado-shaped craft piloted by insectoid aliens crashing at the site of the first atomic bomb detonation. Despite a lack of evidence or internal consistency, the case was cited in the UFO investigation section of the <u>National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2023</u> . ^{[71][72]}
1946	<u>The Ghost Rockets</u>	<u>Scandinavia and other parts of Europe</u>	Thousands of UFO sightings were reported over Europe. Due in part to concerns that foreign governments were testing <u>recovered experimental German technology</u> , the Swedish and Greek governments investigated the reports separately. ^[73]
1946-05-18	<u>Ängelholm UFO memorial</u>	Sweden; <u>Ängelholm, Kristianstads County</u>	Swedish entrepreneur Gösta Carlsson, attributed his success to a 1946 UFO encounter, that he commemorated with a concrete monument. Independent investigations did not verify his account. ^{[74][75][76]}
1947-06-24	<u>Kenneth Arnold UFO sighting</u>	United States; North of <u>Mount Rainier, Washington</u>	Private pilot Kenneth Arnold was flying near <u>Mount Rainier</u> when he reported seeing a group of reflective craft moving at high speeds and flashing in the sun like mirrors. Bill Bequette of the East Oregonian, who first interviewed Arnold, summarized the sighting as, "nine saucer-like aircraft flying in formation." This introduced the term <i>flying saucers</i> , and Arnold's sighting sparked an explosion of UFO reports around the country. ^{[77][78][79][80]}
c. 1947	<u>1947 flying disc craze</u>	United States; <u>Washington and other states</u>	After the Kenneth Arnold sighting was reported in the news, over 800 similar sightings were reported throughout 1947. ^{[81][82]}
1947-07-04	<u>Flight 105 UFO sighting</u>	United States; En route from <u>Boise, Idaho to Pendleton, Oregon</u>	A United Airlines crew including Captain Emil Smith, co-pilot Ralph Stephens, and flight attendant Marty Morrow witnessed nine unidentified objects. Believing them to be aircraft, Smith flashed the plane's landing lights intending to alert the objects which he described as "smooth on the bottom and rough appearing on top". ^{[83][84]}
1947-07-07	<u>Rhodes UFO photographs</u>	United States; <u>Phoenix, Arizona</u>	Inventor and amateur astronomer William Albert Rhodes took photographs of what he described as a silent grey object that appeared after a thunderstorm. The Air Force investigated the photographs and concluded that they showed airborne "paper swept up by the winds". ^{[85][86][87]}
1947-07-08	<u>The Roswell Incident</u>	United States; about 30 mi. north of <u>Roswell, New Mexico</u>	Walter Haut, a <u>United States Army Air Forces</u> spokesperson, issued a press release announcing the "capture" of a " <u>flying saucer</u> ". Hours later, the Army announced that the find was a crashed weather balloon. In 1978, the case regained attention after Jesse Marcel, the Army Officer who recovered the wreckage, told UFO researchers that the weather balloon explanation was a cover story. In 1994, the Air Force attributed the incident to the previously classified <u>Project Mogul</u> . ^[88]
1947-07-29	<u>Maury Island hoax</u>	United States; <u>Puget Sound near Maury Island, Washington</u>	Fred Crisman mailed an account from employee Harold A. Dahl, along with a cigar box of metal wreckage, to <u>Raymond A. Palmer</u> who had previously published the <u>Shaver Mystery</u> stories. Dahl claimed that his dog was killed and his son was injured by debris in an encounter with six flying doughnut-shaped objects. He also reported that he was subsequently threatened by <u>Men in Black</u> . On July 31, 1947, Palmer arranged a meeting between

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			Crisman, Dahl, Air Force investigators, and flying saucer witnesses <u>Kenneth Arnold & Emil Smith</u> . ^{[89][90]}
c. 1948	<u>The Green Fireballs</u>	<u>United States; New Mexico and other parts of the Southwestern United States</u>	The US Air Force investigated reports of green flares streaking across the sky after an Air Force C-47 transport encountered a green ball of fire on 5 December 1948. The pilot, Captain Goede, described the object as larger than a meteor and not arching downward as a meteor would. The Air Force investigation was inconclusive. ^{[91][92]}
1948-01-07	<u>Mantell UFO incident</u>	<u>United States; Kentucky</u>	Captain Thomas F. Mantell, a Kentucky Air National Guard pilot, died in the crash of his P-51 Mustang fighter plane near Franklin, Kentucky, United States, after being sent in pursuit of an unidentified flying object. While following the object, he climbed beyond 25,000 feet (7,600 m) and blacked out from a lack of oxygen. The military later identified the craft he was pursuing as likely a <u>Skyhook weather balloon</u> . ^{[93][94][95]}
1948-03-25	<u>Aztec, New Mexico UFO hoax</u>	<u>United States; New Mexico</u>	Conmen Silas Newton and Leo Gebauer sold "magnetic oil-detecting machines" based on the story that they had replicated technology from a crashed spaceship. The pair were convicted of fraud in 1953. Elements of their story regarding a crashed ship with occupants were later entangled in the Roswell narrative. ^{[96][97][98]}
1948-07-24	<u>Chiles-Whitted UFO encounter</u>	<u>United States; Montgomery, Alabama</u>	Clarence Chiles and John Whitted, American commercial pilots, reported that their airplane had nearly collided with a UFO near Montgomery. According to the pilots the object "looked like a wingless aircraft...it seemed to have two rows of windows through which glowed a very bright light, as brilliant as a magnesium flare." ^{[99][100]}
1948-10-01	<u>Gorman dogfight</u>	<u>United States; North Dakota</u>	A US Air Force pilot sighted and pursued a UFO for 27 minutes over <u>Fargo, North Dakota</u> . According to US Air Force officer <u>Edward J. Ruppelt</u> , this was one of three cases, along with the Mantell incident and Chiles-Whitted encounter, that shifted the Air Force's attitude about UFO reports leading to the creation of <u>Project Blue Book</u> . ^{[101][102]}

1950–1974

Date	Name	Location	Description
1950-05-11	<u>McMinnville UFO photographs</u>	<u>United States</u> ; a farm near <u>McMinnville, Oregon</u>	A farmer took pictures of a purported "flying saucer". These were the first flying saucer photographs since the coining of the term. ^[103]
1950-08-15	<u>Mariana UFO incident</u>	<u>United States</u> ; <u>Great Falls, Montana</u>	The manager of Great Falls' pro baseball team took color film of two UFOs flying over Great Falls. The film was extensively analyzed by the US Air Force and several independent investigators. ^{[104][105]}
1951-01-20	<u>Sioux City mystery plane incident</u>	<u>United States</u> ; <u>Sioux City, Iowa</u>	Two pilots and a military officer passenger aboard a commercial DC-3 reported being buzzed by an unidentified straight-winged plane both larger and more maneuverable than a B-29. ^[106]
1951-08-25	<u>Lubbock Lights</u>	<u>United States</u> ; <u>Lubbock, Texas</u>	Several lights in V-shaped formations were repeatedly spotted flying over the city. Witnesses included W. I. Robinson, A. G. Oberg, and W. L. Ducker, professors of geology, chemical engineering, and petroleum engineering respectively. Teenage student Carl Hart Jr. photographed the lights ^[106]
1952-01-29	<u>Wonsan-Sunchon UFO incident</u>	<u>Korea</u> ; <u>Wonsan and Sunchon</u>	Four American military personnel aboard two different B-29 bombers reported seeing an orange globe-shaped light over two different cities in northern Korea ^[106]
1952-07-12 to 1952-07-29	<u>1952 Washington, D.C. UFO incident</u>	<u>United States</u> ; <u>Washington, D.C.</u>	A series of sightings in July 1952 accompanied <u>radar</u> contacts in the Washington area. These were the first sightings to be widely and seriously reported as potentially physical craft operated by intelligent life from another planet. In response, the CIA formed the Robertson Panel which advised Project Blue Book to "strip the Unidentified Flying Objects of the special status they have been given and the aura of mystery they have unfortunately acquired". ^{[107][108][109]}
1952-07-14	<u>Nash-Fortenberry UFO sighting</u>	<u>United States</u> ; <u>Norfolk, Virginia</u>	William B. Nash and William H. Fortenberry, pilots of a DC-4 airliner of Pan American Airways, radioed the Norfolk <u>civil aviation authority</u> to report eight large, round, glowing red objects. ^{[110][111]}
1952-09-12	<u>The Flatwoods Monster</u>	<u>United States</u> ; <u>Flatwoods, West Virginia</u>	Three local boys followed a bright object into the forest to what they believed was a UFO landing. They went to the nearby home of Kathleen May who accompanied them back to the spot along with two other children and teenage National Guardsman Eugene Lemon. In the forest, they smelled a foul odor and saw what May described as a tall figure with claws and "a head that resembled the ace of spades". ^[112]
1954-09-10	<u>Marius Dewilde sighting</u>	<u>France</u> ; <u>Quarouble, Nord</u>	French metalworker Marius Dewilde claimed to have become a contactee in 1954. Local newspapers and <i>Radar</i> magazine covered Dewilde's story of small humanoid figures landing a ship on the abandoned railroad tracks near his home. The coverage of Dewilde and other 1950s contactees spurred the careers of French ufologists Aimé Michel and Jacques Vallée. ^[113]
1954-10-27	<u>Fiorentina Stadium mass sighting</u>	<u>Italy</u> ; <u>Stadio Artemio Franchi in Florence</u>	A football game between Fiorentina and Pistoiese was under way at the Stadio Artemio Franchi when a group of UFOs traveling at high speed abruptly stopped over the stadium. The stadium became silent as the crowd of around 10,000 spectators witnessed the event and described the UFOs as cigar shaped. ^{[114][115]}
1955-08-21 to 1955-08-22	<u>Kelly–Hopkinsville encounter</u>	<u>United States</u> ; A farmhouse near <u>Hopkinsville, Kentucky</u>	At a rural farmhouse, eleven people witnessed creatures in the night. Two of the men opened fire with a shotgun and rifle, and the entire group later fled to the Hopkinsville police station. The creatures have been variously described as goblins, aliens, "little green men", owls, and circus monkeys. Four officers, five state troopers, three deputies, and four military police investigated the farmhouse finding bullet holes but no monsters. The story has had a broad impact on popular culture. ^{[116][117][118]}
1956-07-24	<u>Lakenheath-Bentwaters incident</u>	<u>United Kingdom</u> ; <u>Suffolk, England</u>	United States Air Force (USAF) and Royal Air Force (RAF) radar operators (from Lakenheath RAF Station, Bentwaters RAF Station, and Sculthorpe RAF Station) detected up to 15 objects over Suffolk. An RAF pilot was sent out from Waterbeach RAF Station in a de Havilland Venom, a jet aircraft with aircraft interception radar. The pilot reported spotting the object on radar and visually

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			observing a luminous white object that moved behind his craft when he attempted to intercept. ^{[119][120]}
1956-08-13	<u>Elizabeth Klarer</u>	<u>South Africa; Drakensberg</u>	A series of photos depicting a supposed UFO were taken on 24 July near Rosetta in the Drakensberg region. The photographer, meteorologist Elizabeth Klarer, claimed detailed adventures with an alien race including having had an alien lover, Akon, who would have fathered her son Ayling. ^{[121][122]}
1957-05-03	<u>Gordon Cooper UFO Sightings</u>	<u>United States; Edwards Air Force Base, California</u>	Gordon Cooper, one of the <u>original Project Mercury astronauts</u> , witnessed a type of metallic craft without wings flying over Germany in the 1950s. At the time, Cooper believed these to be Soviet aircraft. His attitude later changed after an incident at <u>Edwards Air Force Base</u> . Cooper sent a crew of James Bittick and Jack Gettys out to a dry lakebed to set up <u>data-recording photography equipment</u> . Cooper said the two men, both familiar with <u>experimental aircraft</u> , came back shaken and talking about witnessing a wingless aircraft with retractable legs silently land and take off near them. Cooper reported the incident to <u>The Pentagon</u> which asked for all photographs of the craft. Cooper looked at the photos before sending them off and believed that the government covered up a UFO encounter. ^{[123][124]}
1957-05-20	<u>Milton Torres 1957 UFO Encounter</u>	<u>United Kingdom; East Anglia</u>	U.S. Air Force fighter pilot Milton Torres reports that he was ordered to intercept and fire on a UFO displaying "very unusual flight patterns" over East Anglia. Ground radar operators tracked what was believed to be an unidentified aircraft for some time before Torres' plane was scrambled to intercept. ^{[125][126][127][128]}
1957-10-15	<u>Antônio Vilas-Boas Abduction</u>	<u>Brazil; Near São Francisco de Sales, Minas Gerais</u>	Law student Antônio Vilas-Boas described being <u>abducted</u> by humanoid aliens and taken aboard their egg-shaped craft. He also said that he was confined within a small round room where he was compelled to have sex with a four foot tall alien woman. ^[129]
1957-11-02	<u>Levelland UFO case</u>	<u>United States; Levelland, Texas</u>	Drivers observed cigar-shaped lights above the highway, followed by electrical failures. ^[130]
1957-11-04	<u>Kirtland AFB UFO sighting</u>	<u>United States; Albuquerque, New Mexico</u>	Through binoculars, two Civil Aeronautics Administration tower operators reported seeing an egg shape emitting a white light beneath it. ^{[119][120]}
1961-09-19	<u>Betty and Barney Hill abduction</u>	<u>United States; South of Lancaster on Route 3, New Hampshire</u>	The Hills reported the first alien abduction experience to be widely spread in English-language publications. While driving home, they observed a light move through the sky and land ahead of them. Barney Hill said that, against his will, he turned the car down a side road towards the light, where he found six small humanoid beings waiting for them. Betty Hill reported that they inserted a needle through her navel among other vaguely medical tests. ^[131]
1963	<u>Kallamishtëz UFO incident</u>	<u>Albania; Kurvelesh</u>	Residents of Kallamishtëz in the <u>Kurvelesh</u> region reported a bright object in the sky. Albanian authorities said that it was a new jet plane used by the Albanian Air Force. ^{[43][44]}
1964-04-24	<u>Lonnie Zamora incident</u>	<u>United States; Socorro, New Mexico</u>	Police officer Lonnie Zamora investigated a roaring sound. Zamora and a nearby tourist found a craft that took off shortly after their arrival. The craft left impressions in the ground that did not aid in identification. ^[132]
1964-05-23	<u>Solway Firth Spaceman</u>	<u>United Kingdom; Cumbria, England</u>	While on a day trip with his family, fireman Jim Templeton took a photo of his daughter, that when developed showed a mysterious figure in the background. Templeton believed it to be a "spaceman", but later analysis showed it was most likely his wife. ^[133]

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1964-09-18 until 9-24	<u>Dwikora Operation UFO incident</u>	Surabaya, Indonesia	Officer Jacob Salatun—founder of the National Institute of Aeronautics and Space in Indonesia—wrote several books on UFOs and founded an organization to study UFO reports after he served as Minister of Industry. According to Salatun, one night during the Indonesia-Malaysia Confrontation, pilots reported seeing and shooting at a dark, mango-shaped craft with colored lights. Salatun claims that fragments of the military's shells struck individuals outside of their homes in Sidoarjo. ^[134]
1965-06-04	<u>Project Gemini UFO</u>	Low Earth orbit; Above <u>Hawaii</u>	During Gemini 4, astronaut James McDivitt spotted a white cylinder with a protruding arm traveling in his orbit. McDivitt has said that it was impossible for him to assign scale to the object against the black background of space, saying that it could have been small enough to hold in his hands or "the size of the Empire State Building." ^[135]
1965-09-03	<u>The Incident at Exeter</u>	United States; <u>Exeter, New Hampshire</u>	Numerous people reported pulsating UFOs in Exeter, New Hampshire. The events were the subject of <i>The Incident at Exeter</i> by John G. Fuller. ^[136]
1965-07-1	<u>The Valensole UFO incident</u>	France; <u>Valensole, Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur</u>	French farmer, Maurice Massé, witnessed a spherical vehicle in his lavender field. He noticed and approached two individuals that he observed near the vehicle, but after one pointed a tube in his direction, he stood still feeling paralyzed. He described the beings as child-sized, pale, large-headed, with only holes where a mouth should be. Massé said that after they left in their vehicle, he was never again able to grow a healthy plant in the area where the craft had landed. He did not personally comment on the effect this had on him, saying, "One always says too much." His wife reported that the man was plagued with exhaustion for months, that he had confessed some type of communication to her, and that it was a "spiritual experience" for her husband. ^{[137][138]}
1965-12-09	<u>Kecksburg UFO incident</u>	United States; <u>Kecksburg, Pennsylvania</u>	Local newspapers and newscasts reported a fireball observed in the skies over Kecksburg. According to some residents, they found an acorn-shaped object in the woods. The U.S. military closed off the area to investigate and reported no evidence of a crash. A model built for <i>Unsolved Mysteries</i> is kept on display by the fire department, which leads an annual UFO celebration. ^{[139][140][141]}
1966-03-20	<u>Michigan "swamp gas" UFO reports</u>	United States; <u>Dexter, Michigan and Hillsdale, Michigan</u>	Two mass sightings above wetlands were dismissed at a press conference as "marsh gas". ^[142]
1966-04-06	<u>Westall UFO</u>	Australia; <u>Clayton South, Victoria</u>	Several hundred students and school faculty from Westall High School watched an object land at the nearby Grange Reserve. ^[143]
1966-08-20	<u>Lead masks case</u>	Brazil; <u>Niterói, Rio de Janeiro</u>	The bodies of two recently deceased men were found on a hillside in Rio de Janeiro. They wore raincoats and handmade lead masks. A mutual friend, Elcio Gomes, said that the men had been "scientific spiritualists", members of a religious group that attempted to contact extraterrestrials using hallucinogens ^{[144][145]}
1967-05-20	<u>Falcon Lake Incident</u>	Canada; <u>Falcon Lake, Manitoba</u>	Prospector Stefan Michalak attributed unusual burns on his body to a purported UFO sighting near Falcon Lake. ^{[146][147]} Radiation tests done at Misericordia General Hospital came back negative. Higher levels of soil radiation at the area where Michalak said he was burned were traced to an underground vein of radium. ^{[148][149]}
1967-08-29	<u>Close encounter of Cussac</u>	France; near <u>Cussac, Auvergne</u>	A 13-year-old boy and his younger sister reported an incident to their father, local police, and investigators. According to police reports, they witnessed a brilliant sphere and four small black occupants while herding cattle outside their village. ^[150]
1967-09-4	<u>1967 British flying saucer hoax</u>	United Kingdom; <u>Southern England</u>	Apprentices from the Royal Aircraft Establishment constructed six fake flying saucers out of metal-clad fiberglass. They filled them with flour, water, and electronic components, and dropped the saucers off in fields during the night. When a Scotland Yard bomb disposal squad was called in, X-Ray tests revealed the presence of <u>Eveready brand</u> batteries, and the hoax was exposed. ^{[151][152]}